NHMEC

Community Herbalist Diploma

Level II – Applied Studies

MODULE 9

Community Herbal First Aid & Wellness Preparedness

Module Overview

Every community benefits from individuals who are prepared.

Community Herbalists play an important role in educating families, churches, schools, and organizations about preparedness, traditional herbal first aid, and the safe use of herbal preparations for everyday wellness support.

This module is **not** designed to train students as emergency medical providers. Instead, students will learn how to assemble educational herbal first-aid kits, organize supplies, understand traditional herbal applications, and teach others how herbs have historically been used alongside good hygiene, common sense, and appropriate medical care.

Preparedness begins long before an emergency occurs.

By learning to organize supplies, preserve herbs, and educate others, Community Herbalists help build healthier, more resilient communities.

Module Objectives

Upon successful completion of this module, students will be able to:

• Explain the purpose of a community herbal first-aid kit.

• Identify herbs traditionally used for common first-aid situations.

• Organize educational preparedness kits.

• Demonstrate safe storage of herbal preparations.

• Develop herbal first-aid educational materials.

• Understand when referral to emergency medical care is appropriate.

• Promote preparedness within homes, churches, schools, and community organizations.

Required Reading

Read the sections of the **Community Herbalist eGuide** relating to:

• Herbal Preparations

• Community Wellness

• Safety

• Herbal Education

• Community Preparedness

As you read, note:

• Preparation methods

• Safety considerations

• Storage recommendations

• Educational applications

Learning Outcomes

By the end of this module students will understand how Community Herbalists can responsibly educate others about preparedness while recognizing the limits of their educational role.

Instructor Lecture

What Is Community Herbal First Aid?

Community Herbal First Aid focuses on education and preparation.

It emphasizes:

Planning ahead

Organizing supplies

Learning traditional herbal uses

Teaching safe preparation methods

Knowing when professional medical care is necessary

Community Herbalists do not replace emergency medical services.

Instead, they help individuals become better prepared through education and responsible planning.

Building an Educational Herbal First-Aid Kit

A well-organized educational kit should contain:

Clearly labeled herbal preparations

Preparation records

Safety information

Ingredient lists

Storage dates

Educational handouts

Recipe cards

Emergency contact information

Inventory checklist

Instruction notebook

Each kit should remain clean, organized, and regularly inspected.

Suggested Traditional Herbal Preparations

Examples of preparations commonly demonstrated include:

Herbal Salves

Infused Oils

Compresses

Poultices

Herbal Teas

Honey Infusions

Oxymels

Herbal Vinegars

Bath Soaks

Herbal Washes

Each preparation should be clearly labeled with:

Ingredients

Preparation date

Storage recommendations

Educational purpose

Common Educational Topics

Community Herbalists may teach traditional herbal approaches for supporting comfort and wellness in situations such as:

Minor skin irritation

Dry skin

Insect bites

Minor bruising

Muscle soreness

Everyday digestive discomfort

Seasonal wellness

Relaxation

Restful sleep routines

General immune support

Discussions should focus on traditional use, preparation methods, and safety—not on diagnosing or treating medical conditions.

Organization Matters

Professional herbal kits include:

Labeled containers

Alphabetized herbs

Preparation log

Replacement schedule

Cleaning supplies

Gloves

Measuring equipment

Notebook

Reference materials

Good organization increases safety and confidence.

Safe Storage

Store herbal preparations:

Away from direct sunlight

In clean containers

Properly labeled

Away from excessive heat

Out of reach of children unless appropriately supervised

Inspect regularly for spoilage.

When in doubt, discard questionable preparations.

Teaching Preparedness

Community Herbalists may educate families about preparing:

Home herbal kits

Travel kits

Church wellness kits

Camping kits

Garden kits

Classroom demonstration kits

Preparedness reduces confusion during stressful situations.

When to Refer

Community Herbalists should encourage immediate medical evaluation for:

Severe injuries

Heavy bleeding

Difficulty breathing

Chest pain

Loss of consciousness

Suspected poisoning

Broken bones

Severe allergic reactions

High fever with serious symptoms

Any situation requiring emergency care

Knowing your professional boundaries protects everyone involved.

Biblical Reflection

Proverbs 22:3 (KJV)

"A prudent man foreseeth the evil, and hideth himself: but the simple pass on, and are punished."

Preparedness is an act of wisdom. By planning ahead, organizing resources, and educating others responsibly, Community Herbalists help communities become better prepared for everyday challenges.

Vocabulary

Define:

Preparedness

Inventory

Compress

Poultice

Infused Oil

Salve

Herbal Wash

Reference Guide

Safety Data

Emergency Referral

Reflection Questions

1. Why is preparedness important?
2. What belongs in an educational herbal first-aid kit?
3. Why is labeling essential?
4. Why should Community Herbalists maintain preparation records?
5. When should professional medical care be recommended?
6. How can churches benefit from herbal preparedness education?
7. What type of preparedness project would benefit your own community?

Practical Activity

Inventory Your Current Supplies

Review your existing herbal supplies.

Record:

Preparation name

Quantity

Date prepared

Storage condition

Expiration or replacement date

Missing supplies

Develop a plan to improve your inventory.

Educational Kit Exercise

Develop three different educational herbal kits.

Examples:

Home Wellness Kit

Church First-Aid Education Kit

Travel Herbal Kit

For each include:

Purpose

Contents

Labels

Storage

Safety sheet

Inventory checklist

Educational handout

Assignment

Build a Community Herbal First-Aid Manual

Create a professional manual containing:

Introduction

Preparedness principles

Inventory sheets

Kit organization

Traditional herbal preparation guides

Storage recommendations

Safety guidelines

Equipment lists

Educational handouts

Inspection checklist

Emergency referral guidelines

Minimum length:

20–25 pages.

Mini Quiz

1. The primary purpose of Community Herbal First Aid is to:

A. Diagnose emergencies

B. Promote preparedness and education

C. Replace emergency medicine

D. Prescribe medications

2. Herbal preparations should always be:

A. Unlabeled

B. Clearly labeled and dated

C. Stored without containers

D. Shared without instructions

3. Community Herbalists should recommend emergency medical care when:

A. A person has a severe injury or emergency

B. Someone requests herbal tea

C. Preparing an infused oil

D. Teaching a workshop

4. A well-organized herbal kit should include:

A. Inventory records

B. Safety information

C. Labels

D. All of the above

5. Good preparedness includes:

A. Waiting until an emergency occurs

B. Planning and organizing ahead of time

C. Avoiding education

D. Ignoring expiration dates

Answer Key

1. B
2. B
3. A
4. D
5. B

Module Project

Design a Community Herbal Preparedness Program

Develop a preparedness program suitable for a church, community center, homeschool cooperative, or neighborhood organization.

Include:

Mission Statement

Preparedness goals

Educational classes

Suggested herbal kits

Workshop schedule

Volunteer responsibilities

Budget

Supply lists

Educational handouts

Annual inspection schedule

Evaluation forms

Minimum length:

10–12 pages.

Community Herbal Journal

Record:

• Five herbal preparations you believe belong in every educational first-aid kit.

• Three improvements you made to your own preparedness supplies.

• Two ways preparedness strengthens communities.

• One goal for teaching preparedness within your community.

Module Completion Checklist

☐ Required reading completed

☐ Vocabulary completed

☐ Reflection questions answered

☐ Supply inventory completed

☐ Three educational kits developed

☐ Community Herbal First-Aid Manual submitted

☐ Preparedness program completed

☐ Quiz passed (80% or higher)

☐ Herbal Journal updated

Instructor Challenge (Optional)

Prepare and present a **45-minute "Herbal Preparedness for the Home"** educational workshop.

Include:

• Herbal kit demonstration

• Labeling examples

• Storage recommendations

• Preparedness checklists

• Traditional herbal preparation examples

• Question-and-answer session

Collect participant evaluations and include them in your Community Herbalist Portfolio.

Looking Ahead

In **Module 10**, you will explore **Community Nutrition & Food as Herbal Medicine**, learning how culinary herbs, nourishing foods, seasonal eating, and traditional kitchen remedies can be incorporated into community wellness education through cooking demonstrations, meal planning, and nutrition-focused outreach programs.